

Inclusive Supports in Education

- ▶ DAY 4
- ▶ Education Assistant Program
- ▶ Instructor: Leonie Stephens

Agenda

Adapted & Modified Curriculum

- Differentiated Instruction
- Universal Design for Learning
- Modifications vs Adaptations
- Roles and collaboration
- Types of adaptations
- Scribing for students
- Examples of adaptations

Differentiated Instruction

Differentiated Instruction (DI) is a method of approaching the planning and implementation of curriculum and instruction acknowledging that individual learners will have different levels of aptitude, achievement, interest, motivation, needs and ability.

Three Principles Guide Differentiation of Learning

The three principles are:

1. Learning requires the active participation of the student.
2. Students learn in a variety of ways and at different rates.
3. Learning is both an individual and a group process.

Differentiated Instruction (DI)



This is a flexible approach to teaching that enables all learners to participate in instruction, tasks and assessment



Instruction focusses on the strengths of students and minimizes weaknesses by using effective learning strategies and technology as appropriate. This is personalized and inclusive



It involves ensuring regular check-ins with individual students to determine if instruction has been effective and for timely remediation when needed



This increases student motivation and self-esteem as students experience successful learning



It will not be unusual to be supporting more than one child at a time in a classroom situation requiring differentiated instruction to meet their unique needs

Summary of Differentiated Instruction

Flexible to Student

- ▶ content
- ▶ delivery
- ▶ tasks
- ▶ assessment
- ▶ learning environment

The Educational Assistant will know if a student is on an adapted or modified program in order to tailor instruction appropriately

Ongoing assessment of learning and immediate adjustment to remediate in a timely manner is a never-ending process and your responsibility

Suggestions for Differentiation of Learning Environment

- ▶ Consider the physical elements of the room and how these impact the learner positively or negatively throughout the day
- ▶ Try to minimize distractions that may impact the learner adversely
- ▶ Look at furniture arrangement/spaces. In consultation with teacher, provide what might be needed
- ▶ Teach the student how to make personal choices for optimum learning environment, considering self-regulation needs at that moment
- ▶ Avoid sending a child to an area of the room as punishment as it will quickly lose its effectiveness and you will not be teaching self-regulation
- ▶ Encourage students to self-evaluate and take responsibility for own learning needs at any given time

Universal Design for Learning (UDL)

UDL accommodates varied learning styles. It provides learning activities that expand student opportunities for acquiring information and demonstrating learning, as well as for enhancing social participation and inclusion

This model makes diversity the norm. It provides support for all students and motivates through the element of choice

How Do We Implement UDL?

Instruction

Offer information/lessons using a multisensory approach

Post the goals for lessons so that students are aware of what they are intended to learn and can self-evaluate success or need for help

Post-it notes are perfect for this

Flexibility

Offer different options to demonstrate learning

Simplify or enhance tasks

Text enlargement

Screen colour/contrast

Video with captions

Transcripts with audio

Motivation

Offer ways to motivate students to engage in learning and take personal responsibility for learning

Choices

Relevant/meaningful tasks

Games for boring skill building

Movement

How Do We Implement UDL?

1. Provide flexible workspaces and choices

- ▶ Individual, small group, large group, full group
- ▶ Encourage self-reflection and self-evaluation

2. Provide regular check-ins and feedback on how students are doing and provide prompt intervention when needed

- ▶ Encourage and teach student self-reflection skills and self-evaluation skills

Adapted and Modified Educational Programs



Adapted Educational Programs

- ▶ A student working on learning outcomes at any grade or course level may be supported through the use of adaptations.
- ▶ Adaptations may include alternate formats for resources, instructional strategies and/or assessment procedures.

Some examples of adaptations include:

- Breaking tasks into smaller parts;
- Different ways of demonstrating learning such as oral exams, visual representation;
- Different formats for resources to enable students to receive information, such as assistive technology

Adapted Educational Programs

- ▶ The Ministry of Education, Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines describes adaptations as:
- ▶ “teaching and assessment strategies especially designed to accommodate a student’s needs so he or she can achieve the learning outcomes/ standards of the subject or course and to demonstrate proficiency of concepts.”

Adapted Educational Programs

- ▶ A **Dogwood Graduation Diploma** recognizes the successful completion of the BC curriculum and is recognized internationally
- ▶ Students receiving adaptations are usually working towards the same Dogwood Graduation Diploma as their peers
- ▶ If a student is working on course/subject learning outcomes at a lower grade level than their peer age group, they may take longer to achieve their Dogwood Graduation Diploma
- ▶ The provision of adaptations acknowledges that some students may need extra time to graduate

Adaptations for Students Graduating with a Dogwood Diploma

All students can access adaptations to support their learning.

Adaptations:

- are curriculum, instruction and assessment strategies
- are used to accommodate student learning needs
- create a flexible learning environment
- are design practices that offer students choice in their expression, representation and engagement with the curriculum and may include: multiple and diverse texts; flexible seating arrangements, multiple and varied working spaces; scaffolded learning; visuals and graphic organizers; extended time; scribing

Modified Educational Programs

- ▶ The Ministry of Education, Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines describes a modified program as:

“Instructional and assessment-related decisions are made to address a student’s educational needs that consist of individualized learning goals as opposed to provincial learning outcomes”.

Modified Educational Programs

- ▶ Modified programming is for students whose special needs are such that they are unable to access the learning outcomes of the curriculum. For example:
 - ▶ Students with limited awareness of their surroundings
 - ▶ Students with fragile mental/physical health
 - ▶ Students significantly challenged medically and/or intellectually
- ▶ A student's educational program CANNOT be modified without consultation with parents or guardians and an IEP must be created

Modified Educational Programs

- ▶ Students on modified programs are assessed in relation to the goals and objectives established in their Individual Education Plan (IEP).
- ▶ Students on a modified program receive an **Evergreen Certificate** upon school completion. This is not a graduation certificate. It is a leaving certificate
- ▶ Some students spend an extra year in public school to complete the goals in their IEP

Modifications

- ▶ Are individualized learning goals that are significantly different from the learning standards of a course or subject
- ▶ Are required to be identified in an IEP
- ▶ Usually include functional life skills and foundational academic skills
- ▶ Should be considered for those who are unable to access the regular curriculum

Modifications

- ▶ Are meant to be a rare practice
- ▶ May comprise only part of an educational program
- ▶ Need not be a permanent or long term solution
- ▶ Are meant to be thoughtfully agreed in consultation with parents, administration, and other professionals
- ▶ Should address long-term education, career, and life goals to facilitate the best overall outcome for the individual student

Examples of Modifications

- Functional literacy skills e.g. learning how to listen to stories at a pre-primary level and when to turn the page at the appropriate time using assistive technology.
- Communication skills e.g., use of PECS system, use of voice output devices
- Self-care skills e.g., brushing teeth, toileting, dressing
- Life skills e.g., food preparation, doing laundry, use of public transit system
- Work experience for low incidence students i.e., at secondary level

Adapted Educational Program	Modified Educational Program
Any student who are able to meet the learning outcomes of the regular curriculum with adaptations.	Students who are unable to meet the learning outcomes of the regular curriculum because of limited awareness of their surroundings, fragile mental/physical health, or who are medically and cognitively challenged.
Alternate resources, instructional strategies or assessment procedures used to help the student meet the learning outcomes of the regular curriculum.	Alternate resources, instructional strategies or assessment procedures used to help the student meet individualized goals documented in the Individual Education Plan (IEP) that are significantly different than the regular curriculum.
Examples of adaptations include use of computers, extra time, reduced number of assigned questions, scribe/voice recognition software, graphic organizers, spell check, enlarged print, novels on tape, preferential seating etc. These adaptations support the student in meeting the learning outcomes of the regular curriculum.	Examples of modifications include functional literacy skills (print name, recite address, recognize signs); functional math skills (money, use of calendar, tell time); communication skills (PECs etc); self-care skills (brushing teeth, toileting, dressing); life skills (food preparation, doing laundry, use of public transit).
Students receives letter grades and is working toward a Dogwood Graduation Diploma.	Student is working toward an Evergreen School Leaving Certificate.
Not all students on an adapted educational program have IEPs. If there is no formal designation or diagnosis, the student will have a Personal Learning	Parents must be consulted before any modified program is implemented.

Whose Role is it to Adapt/Modify?

Teacher (Classroom
Teacher and/or
Case Manager)

Determines
appropriate
adaptations and
modifications in
line with IEP

Shared

Work together to
adapt/modify
curriculum and
resource material

Education Assistant

Adapts strategies
to accommodate
individual learner
needs/styles

Suggestions for Parallel Activities for Students with Diverse Needs

- ▶ You can work with the teacher/learning support teacher to examine the curriculum Big Ideas and with the IEP to determine what the student might be able to accomplish
- ▶ Your over-arching goal is the social and academic inclusion of your student while developing the unique goals and objectives listed in the IEP
- ▶ You may need to get creative to develop activities that your student can successfully engage in. Think about how this work can be done with peers even for a portion of the time
- ▶ If inclusion has not been a successful part of the education of the student you are supporting, you will need to take time to train or prepare your student and perhaps their peers for inclusive learning experiences

Adaptations

Adaptations are sometimes called “accommodations”

- ▶ They may be clustered in the following categories:
 - ▶ Content
 - ▶ Process
 - ▶ Product
 - ▶ Environment
 - ▶ Assessment and Evaluation

Adaptations

Adaptations might be thought of as adjustments to how students:

- ▶ take in information (input)
- ▶ participate in learning activities (engagement/process)
- ▶ demonstrate their learning (output)

Adaptations do not represent unfair advantages to students. In fact, if appropriate adaptations are not used, students could be unfairly penalized for having learning differences, creating serious negative impacts to their achievement and self-concept.

Types of Curriculum Adaptations

- ▶ **Quantity of work to be completed:** It can be reduced or increased as required
- ▶ **Time allotted for work:** It can be reduced or increased as required
- ▶ **Level of Support:** Increase or decrease personal assistance or prompts
- ▶ **Instruction:** Adapt the way that the instruction is delivered to the student (visual aids, enlarge text, provide more concrete examples, use cooperative groups, pre-teach key vocabulary or ideas, review lessons)
- ▶ **Environmental:** Offer a quiet area in the classroom or other supervised area where student can work

Types of Curriculum Adaptations

- ▶ **Difficulty:** Adapt the skill level, problem type, or the manner with which the student will complete the work. For example, allow the student to use a calculator for math problems, simplify task directions, provide a graphic organizer to support getting ideas down on paper...
- ▶ **Change how the student demonstrates learning:** For example, instead of writing down response, the student dictates the response or part of the response
- ▶ **Participation:** Allow for the student to be more actively involved in lessons by giving meaningful tasks such as holding the item that is being shown to the class, or turning the pages for the instructor, or moving items for the instructor during the lesson

Check in

- ▶ The EA is expected to provide well thought out adaptations in consultation with the enrolling and/or resource teacher
- ▶ You should ask for one of these staff to check your idea for differentiation especially when you are first starting out
- ▶ As your confidence grows, you will need to check in less often, but it is always good for the teacher to know what you are doing with the students



Adaptations - Scribing

One of the more common adaptations an EA may do is **scribing** for a student. When you are scribing you need to be aware of a few things:

- ▶ What is scribing?
 - ▶ Scribing is when you write down the ideas, thoughts, answers for a student
- ▶ Scribing not doing the work for a student
- ▶ Confirm with the teacher if the assignment is going to be used for assessment

Adaptations

Choice of
response

Choice of
materials

Graphic
organizers

Test-taking
strategies

Organization
strategies

Note taking
strategies

Adaptations

Reduced
workload/demand

Team Teaching

Small group
instruction /
Individual
instruction

Group work /
strategic
groupings

Partner talk /
discussion

Quiet location to
work / Learning
center

Other Common Adaptations

Peer helper to assist with assigned readings

Assistive tools/technology such as word processor, calculator, text to speech/voice to text software, magnifier, FM system...

Alternative ways of demonstrating learning standards

Extended time to complete assignments/tests

Pre-teaching key vocabulary or concepts; multiple exposure to materials, exercises, concepts...

Working on select learning standards from different grade levels (to be determined in collaboration with teacher)

Adaptations in the Classroom Activity

Activity:

- ▶ In groups of 2 - 3, review the student profile summary in the handout Adaptations in the Classroom Activity
- ▶ Review the Potential Adaptations handout and these PowerPoint slides to select some **adaptations** you think would support the student's learning.
- ▶ Write them down and be prepared to share with the class.
- ▶ Large group sharing

Examples of Adaptations: Reading

Where /when	What Subject Area	Resources/Materials	Looks Like
Classroom Period 2 on Tuesdays and Thursdays	Reading	• Age-appropriate low vocabulary books • Strategies for reading: look at the pictures, look for familiar parts in the word, read before and after to see what word would makes sense • All in red box with picture of rabbit on it at the back of the class	• Give time to go through her strategies, will look up when she is stuck. • Sound the beginning sound for her to queue and continue to the next sound. • Explain the meaning of the word and what it means in the story. • Get her to read it again and continue on.

Examples of Adaptations: Writing

Where When	What Subject Area	Resources/ Materials	Looks Like
Classroom throughout day	Writing	• Paper and markers • Graphic organizer • Materials found in her writing box at the back of the class	• Review the key points of the assignment • She is to draw the key points/ideas for her story on her graphic organizer • Encourage her to write as much as she can by posing questions to elaborate on the composition • Usually, she will write one sentence • Do not correct her. • She is to draw the rest of her story

Examples of Adaptations: Vocabulary

Where/ When	What Subject Area	Resources/ Materials	Looks Like
Resource Room on Monday and Thursday 9:30-10:15	Vocabulary	• Vocabulary book • Vocabulary graphic organizer • Coloured pencils • Pencil • Found in her tote box at the back of	• Have her write the 2 new vocabulary words on her graphic organizer. • Do one word at time. • Ask what she thinks the word is and what it could mean. • Go over what it means and give examples of it in simple language. • Brainstorm with her words that are the same(synonyms) and opposite(antonyms) • She can draw pictures of these in the

When a Teacher Tells You How They Wish For You To Provide Support

- ▶ It is your role to follow the directions of the teacher whether you agree or not
- ▶ Before you engage in conversations about any strategies or resources you might want to use that differ from what the teacher has been instructing you to use, build a trusting relationship with the teacher

Be conscious of your role and authority within the job of the EA

- ▶ Be careful not to overstep your role or authority
- ▶ The teacher is ultimately responsible and accountable for what happens in the classroom
- ▶ Be curious and ask questions rather than make statements that could be viewed as judgmental. Sometimes when we ask questions it helps everyone to think further on the topic



Classroom Adaptations

5 Types of Instructional Adaptations for Your Inclusive Classroom

Read the article and answer the following question:

- ▶ What strategies for adapting materials, tasks, assignments, and the learning environment do you think an EA could do?
- ▶ Your reflections should be ~250 words

<https://blog.brookespublishing.com/5-types-of-instructional-adaptations-for-your-inclusive-classroom/>